

COINPICKS · RESEARCH & EDUCATION

Iran War Risk Pillar Report

Middle East Conflict Risk — Researched, Scored, and Personally Committed

Originally written June 19, 2026; scores committed by me June 19, 2026. Fully re-researched July 8, 13, 18, 25, and 30, 2026, and again as a full weekly refresh on August 8, 2026 (P cut at 1mo/3mo, 24/31/41/56/77 → 20/28/41/56/77, committed and stamped by Alex, last COMMITTED baseline). The Aug 16-22 gap saw four abandoned drafts: Aug 17 (held flat), Aug 18 (cut to 17/25/38/54/76), Aug 20 (cut to 16/24/38/54/76, left for manual review over a UAE missile claim), and Aug 21 (a session got partway through delivering the Aug 20 numbers — 2 of 6 reports touched, no render/selfcheck/archive/commit — before stopping). None were rendered, archived, or committed. An Aug 22 morning catch-up cycle (score set **2026-08-22_draft**) independently re-verified the gap via four parallel primary-source research passes, then adversarially fact-checked the load-bearing new claims before delivery — a step that caught a real error (see below) — and cut P to 14/22/38/54/76, delivered as a draft flagged for manual review. **Correction #1 (confirmed accurate):** the UAE missile-attack claim (Aug 18) remains single-source (UAE MoD only, Iran denies and calls it a possible "false flag") and was NOT the first direct attack on the UAE as prior drafts framed it — UAE was hit by a missile/drone barrage Apr 1-8 and again at its Fujairah port May 4, both Iran-attributed by UAE's own government and predating Aug 18; that "novel escalation vector" framing is retired. **Correction #2 (a genuine miss, caught on adversarial re-check):** that draft initially described a fatal strike on the bulker Minoan Dignity (chief engineer killed, Aug 17-18) as "the first confirmed fatality" in the Hormuz tanker campaign — that is FALSE; it is one of a cumulative toll of seafarer deaths since the campaign began late February 2026 this report never previously surfaced or scored on. The Iranian vessel seizure (tanker Amara, held near Qeshm Island since Aug 17, first since June 22) IS confirmed accurate. **THIS VERSION (score set 2026-08-22_draft2) is a separate, later-in-the-day FULL WEEKLY refresh** — the first deep multi-source dive since Aug 8 — that independently re-researched the pillar and ran a second, dedicated adversarial-verification pass specifically re-checking (a) whether the casualty-toll figure holds up and (b) whether anything was missed Aug 19-22. It holds up, but softer than a clean number: cross-checking Wikipedia's "2026 Strait of Hormuz crisis" infobox (18 total), a mid-July gCaptain snapshot ("at least 15"), and IMO's own incident tracker (19 seafarer deaths, but scoped to the broader Middle East, not Hormuz cleanly) puts the honest range at **15-19 cumulative deaths (17-18 by the most Hormuz-specific**

The Scores — Committed vs. Drafts
A UAE missile-attack claim the adversarial pass initially flagged as a possible miss June column committed by me June 19, 2026 · Aug 8 (cut at 1mo/3mo, full weekly refresh) committed and stamped by Alex · Aug 9-16 are turned out, on reconciliation to be the same Aug 18 episode already in the draft light daily touches, all held flat (no cycle ran Aug 15) · Aug 17-21 drafted but never delivered · **Aug 22 draft2** (four parallel research passes baseline, not a second incident. No new kinetic incident was found Aug 19-22. **P HELD** plus two dedicated adversarial passes, cut to 14/22/38/54/76, HELD FLAT vs. the morning draft) was left as a draft at delivery (full weekly refresh this cycle at 14/22/38/54/76 — **left as a draft, not auto-stamped**, because this is a full weekly refresh, categorically excluded from auto-stamp, then reviewed and **COMMITTED BY ALEX on August 23** after independent re-verification of the math and the research trail, see My Decision below. A daily catch-up draft dated August 28, 2026 **refresh** — the first genuinely two-sided evidence ledger in several cycles (a confirmed, crypto-specific sanctions escalation vs. a confirmed Oman-side de-escalation upgrade) — P HELD FLAT at 14/22/38/54/76. Left as draft at delivery per house rules (full weekly refreshes are (score set 2026-08-28 draft) re-checked two more Hormuz tanker incidents and a categorically excluded from auto-stamp, regardless of move size); awaiting Alex's manual review. single-source Iran-Oman revenue-sharing claim, holding P flat — but that draft was never rendered, selfchecked, archived, or committed, and is treated as abandoned/superseded, the same discipline this report has applied to every other interrupted session (Aug 17, 18, 20, and 21). **THIS VERSION (score set 2026-08-29 draft) is a NEW FULL WEEKLY refresh** ago 0.60 the last committed baseline (2026-08-22 draft2) — the first cycle in several weeks to surface a genuinely two-sided evidence ledger: a confirmed, crypto-specific sanctions escalation (the Aug 24 "Operation Economic Outcast" package, the first Iran sanctions action to explicitly name digital assets as a sanctionable sector and list 30 on-chain addresses, confirmed via direct fetch of home.treasury.gov) against a confirmed de-escalation upgrade (Oman's own Foreign Ministry, not just Iran, co-confirming a temporary Hormuz corridor Aug 25, confirmed via direct fetch of fm.gov.om). The two roughly offset, alongside a first-of-the-crisis Hormuz transit uptick and a second straight weekly Brent decline on the bull side, and two more tanker incidents plus a firmer casualty count on the bear side. **P HELD FLAT at 14/22/38/54/76 — left as a draft, not auto-stamped**, because this is a full weekly refresh, categorically excluded from delegated auto-stamp authority regardless of move size (here, zero). See My Decision below.

WINDOW	JUN	...	8/22	8/29	QUAL.	IMP.	SIGNAL	MY CALL
abandoned/superseded, the same discipline this report has applied to every other interrupted session (Aug 17, 18, 20, and 21).			(COMMITTED)	(DRAFT)				
29 draft this is a NEW, independent FULL WEEKLY refresh ago 0.60 the last committed baseline (2026-08-22 draft2) — the first cycle in several weeks to surface a genuinely two-sided evidence ledger: a confirmed, crypto-specific sanctions escalation (the Aug 24 "Operation Economic Outcast" package, the first Iran sanctions action to explicitly name digital assets as a sanctionable sector and list 30 on-chain addresses, confirmed via direct fetch of home.treasury.gov) against a confirmed de-escalation upgrade (Oman's own Foreign Ministry, not just Iran, co-confirming a temporary Hormuz corridor Aug 25, confirmed via direct fetch of fm.gov.om). The two roughly offset, alongside a first-of-the-crisis Hormuz transit uptick and a second straight weekly Brent decline on the bull side, and two more tanker incidents plus a firmer casualty count on the bear side. P HELD FLAT at 14/22/38/54/76 — left as a draft, not auto-stamped , because this is a full weekly refresh, categorically excluded from delegated auto-stamp authority regardless of move size (here, zero). See My Decision below.	3 months	55	...	22	0.65	8	+3.46	Strong Bear — the worst 1-month signal in the whole matrix, held flat this cycle despite a confirmed new sanctions escalation, offset by a confirmed Oman-side de-escalation upgrade
	6 months	62	...	38	0.70	8	-1.34	Mild Bear
	1 year	75	...	54	0.65	8	+0.42	Neutral — dip-buy thesis thinning further

3 years

85

...

76

76

0.55

8

+2.29

Bull

COINPICKS PILLAR REPORT · WEIGHT: 25% OF MY THESIS
Committed P (last stamped, Aug 22 draft2, stamped by Alex Aug 23): 14 / 22 / 38 / 54 / 76 · **Draft P (this cycle, 2026-08-29 draft):** 14 / 22 / 38 / 54 / 76 (HELD FLAT) · **Weight:** 20% (equal) · **Impact:** 8 (uniform) · **Formula:** Signal = ((P - 50) ÷ 50) × Quality × Impact. Full lineage: June committed 50/55/62/75/85 (Jun 19) → ... (see prior versions of this report for the full Jul 8–Aug 21 path) → Aug 22 draft2 committed by Alex August 23, 2026 (2026-08-22 draft2) · Not Financial Advice
August 23, 2026 — last COMMITTED baseline → Aug 28 daily catch-up draft (2026-08-28 draft), held flat at 14/22/38/54/76, **never rendered, selfchecked, archived, or committed — abandoned/superseded** per house discipline, same treatment as the Aug 17-21 gap → **Aug 29 draft (2026-08-29 draft) 14/22/38/54/76 (HELD FLAT)** — a NEW full weekly refresh independently re-researching Aug 23-29, surfacing for the first time in several cycles a genuinely two-sided ledger (a confirmed, crypto-named sanctions escalation Aug 24 vs. a confirmed Oman-government-level de-escalation upgrade Aug 25) that roughly offsets — left as draft at delivery (full weekly refresh, categorically excluded from delegated daily auto-stamp authority); awaiting Alex's manual review.

THE THREE INPUTS, IN PLAIN ENGLISH

P — the odds this is good for crypto by then. Held flat this cycle at 14/22/38/54/76, unchanged from the Aug 22 committed baseline — **left as a draft, not auto-stamped**, because this is a full weekly refresh, categorically excluded from delegated auto-stamp authority regardless of move size (here, zero). This is the first cycle in several weeks where the evidence genuinely pulls in both directions at once, rather than skewing one way. **BEARISH and CONFIRMED: the "Operation Economic Outcast" sanctions package, Aug 24.** Directly fetched from home.treasury.gov: press release sb0613 ("Treasury Launches Unprecedented Campaign Against Iranian Regime on Economic D-Day") and sb0614 (Bessent's remarks), plus an OFAC recent-actions entry dated 20260824 — corroborated by state.gov and 3+ independent trade-compliance/crypto-intelligence outlets (TRM Labs, Chainalysis, CryptoTimes) plus law-firm client alerts. ~60 entities/individuals/vessels were designated across Hong Kong, China, Malaysia, UAE, Singapore, and Switzerland under five sectoral determinations (EO 13902). Critically, this is the FIRST TIME digital assets was

explicitly named as a sanctionable sector under this program — 30 crypto addresses across Bitcoin, Ethereum, and TRON were listed. Unlike the sanctions this pillar tracked in prior cycles as "promised but not landed" (Bessent's rhetoric through Aug 22), this is real, primary-confirmed, and directly crypto-relevant — a genuine escalation. It continued Aug 28 with a new Bank Melli-Dubai designation. Two more Hormuz "unknown projectile" tanker incidents fired this window: Aug 24 off Oman (engine-room damage, disabled, no casualties, UKMTO) and Aug 27 (fire, extinguished, crew safe, UKMTO) — both comparable in severity to the already-established pattern. CENTCOM commander Adm. Brad Cooper gave an on-record briefing Aug 28 (corroborated by UPI, The National, Washington Times, The Hill, RedState, IranWire): US forces cleared Iranian sea mines from the internationally-recognized shipping lanes; ~1,500 commercial vessels have transited since blockade enforcement began; ~75 vessels turned back and 3 disabled for evading the blockade; no oil has been exported from Iran since the blockade resumed — read as continuation/intensification of an existing posture, not a new shock. IMO's six-month casualty count (Aug 28, quasi-primary IMO briefing, corroborated by 4 outlets) settles at 19-20 dead (seafarers + port workers) across 68-70 incidents — the upper end of the previously-reported 15-19 range, a slight negative confirmation, not a new shock. **BULLISH and CONFIRMED: Oman's own Foreign Ministry co-confirmed a Hormuz corridor, Aug 25.** Directly fetched from fm.gov.om/en/53722 (Oman's own government site) — a genuine upgrade, because in every prior cycle only Iran claimed a Hormuz deal and Oman had not confirmed it; now Oman's own ministry co-hosts the statement. Terms: a temporary 7-mile-wide joint navigational corridor (entry/exit through Iranian waters), a joint mine-clearing project, and continuing technical talks toward a permanent corridor per the "Islamabad Memorandum." Still explicitly described as "temporary" — Iran itself said Aug 26 the Strait "remains closed" pending US compliance with the lapsed June MoU. No public fee/revenue terms were disclosed in the joint statement; a separate IRGC spokesman claim (Aug 26) of an Iran-Oman revenue-sharing deal remains single-source and unconfirmed by Oman — correctly excluded from scoring, same treatment as prior single-source claims. Trump declared the Strait "demined" with a zero-tolerance policy on new mines Aug 25 (Reuters, Axios, France24, US News) — undercut two days later by the Aug 27 tanker attack above. The first quantified Hormuz transit-volume increase of the entire crisis: +30%+ week-over-week for the week of Aug 17-23 (USNI News, citing Lloyd's List Intelligence — quasi-primary shipping data, 2 independent pieces Aug 21 & Aug 28) — 114 transits vs. 87 the prior week (westbound 29→42); still a small fraction (~10-15%) of the ~110-130/day (~770-910/week) pre-war baseline, but the first confirmed uptick of the whole crisis. Brent eased for a SECOND straight week: ~\$88.24 (Aug 25) → ~\$89.13-89.3 (Aug 27, weekly loss >5%) → ~\$88.29-90.55 (Aug 28) — down from ~\$93-95 (Aug 20-21), moving further away from the \$100/bbl flip line, with press explicitly framing it as "war premium unwinding" on the Hormuz progress. No new confirmed US combat death Aug 22-29 (checked directly — one initial-looking hit, Sgt. Michael Emmanuel Swinton, was actually killed Jul 18-19, already counted in the standing casualty total, not a new event) — the flip line remains unfired. No new US/CENTCOM strikes on Iran found — GlobalSecurity's Day-181 tracker (checked Aug 27) confirms a 28th consecutive night with no confirmed strike. **Net assessment: the new escalation and the new de-escalation roughly offset.** The pillar's own explicit upside flip line — a signed, US-accepted Hormuz deal holding a full clean week without a new attack/fatality/seizure — is NOT met, since the Aug 27 attack breaks the "clean week" clause and the corridor deal remains Iran+Oman only (not US-accepted). Consistent with this pillar's standing discipline against chasing single-cycle mixed signals in either direction: P HELD FLAT on all five windows.

Quality — how trustworthy the evidence is. The sanctions package rests on a direct primary-source fetch (home.treasury.gov, OFAC) plus state.gov and 3+ independent trade-compliance/crypto-intelligence outlets — above the sufficiency bar, and the strongest-sourced escalation this pillar has logged in weeks. The Oman corridor confirmation rests on a direct primary-source fetch of Oman's own government site (fm.gov.om) — likewise above the bar, and a genuine upgrade in source quality versus the Iran-only claims this pillar discounted in prior cycles. The IRGC revenue-sharing claim remains single-source (Iranian state military) and unconfirmed by Oman — correctly reported as flagged, not used. The transit-volume increase rests on quasi-primary shipping data (Lloyd's List via USNI News) corroborated across two independent pieces — above the bar for a data point, though still a single data provider. Quality (the 0-1 input) itself is unchanged this cycle per house rules.

Impact — 8 out of 10, the uniform value shared by every pillar in the equal-weight model. BTC closed at \$77,666.16 on Aug 29 (Bitstamp), up from \$77,266.84 on Aug 22 — a modest further gain over a window when this pillar's own evidence moved in both directions at once (a real sanctions escalation, a real de-escalation upgrade). That tape move is already reflected in the quant pillar, not an Iran-specific reaction, and per house discipline this pillar's score is not adjusted to chase or match it.

The Claim

The thesis, and where I differ from the consensus — updated August 29, 2026

The crowd: is likely to grab whichever half of this week's ledger fits its priors — either "sanctions finally hit crypto directly, this is the real escalation" or "Oman's own government confirmed a corridor, the war is winding down" — while missing that both are true at once, and that neither, on its own, clears the bar this pillar sets for a re-rate.

Me: holding flat at 14/22/38/54/76 versus the last committed baseline (2026-08-22_draft2, stamped by Alex Aug 23) — this is a NEW full weekly refresh, independently re-researching the week of Aug 23-29, and I'm leaving it as a draft rather than committing it (full weekly refreshes are categorically excluded from delegated auto-stamp authority, regardless of move size). An Aug 28 daily catch-up draft in between held P flat too, but it was never rendered, selfchecked, archived, or committed — I'm treating it as abandoned, the same discipline this report applies to every other interrupted session, and re-researching the full week from the last committed baseline rather than trusting that draft at face value. This is the first cycle in a while where the evidence is genuinely two-sided rather than skewing one way: I confirmed a real, primary-sourced, crypto-specific sanctions escalation (Treasury's "Operation Economic Outcast," Aug 24 — the first time this program has named digital assets as a sanctionable sector and listed on-chain addresses) directly against home.treasury.gov and OFAC. And I confirmed a real de-escalation upgrade — Oman's own Foreign Ministry, not just Iran, co-confirming a temporary Hormuz corridor Aug 25 — directly against Oman's own government site (fm.gov.om). That's a genuine change in source quality from every prior cycle, where I've discounted Iran-only claims about this same corridor. I also chased down a first-of-the-crisis data point: Hormuz transit volume is up 30%+ week-over-week, the first confirmed uptick since the war began, though still a small fraction of the pre-war baseline.

My edge: the crowd tends to anchor on whichever single headline lands first and run with it — a sanctions splash or a corridor announcement — without checking whether the other side of the ledger moved too, or whether either one actually clears this pillar's own flip line. This cycle, the discipline is refusing to let a real, confirmed escalation (sanctions) push P down further while an equally real, confirmed de-escalation (Oman's corridor) is sitting right next to it — and refusing to let the corridor announcement push P up either, because it's temporary, doesn't hold past a single tanker attack two days later (Aug 27), and still isn't a US-accepted deal. Holding flat here isn't indecision — it's the correct read of a ledger that nets close to zero.

Honesty check against the tape: BTC rose from \$77,266.84 (Aug 22 close) to \$77,666.16 (Aug 29, Bitstamp) — a modest further gain — over a window when this pillar's own evidence moved in both directions at once (a real sanctions escalation, a real de-escalation upgrade). Per this system's own discipline, this pillar's score is **not** adjusted to chase or match BTC's move — it scores evidence, not price action — but the comparison itself is logged here explicitly as an honesty check for the reader.

The Facts

As of August 29, 2026 — hard numbers only, sources on the last page. This is a NEW FULL WEEKLY refresh (score set 2026-08-29_draft) against the last COMMITTED baseline (2026-08-22_draft2, stamped by Alex Aug 23) — an intervening Aug 28 daily catch-up draft (2026-08-28_draft) was never rendered, selfchecked, archived, or committed and is treated as abandoned; this cycle's findings appear first, then facts carried forward from Aug 22 and earlier, re-verified where noted (still load-bearing).

★ ★ **NEW** — "Operation Economic Outcast" sanctions package, Aug 24, **CONFIRMED** via direct fetch of **home.treasury.gov**. Press releases sb0613 ("Treasury Launches Unprecedented Campaign Against Iranian Regime on Economic D-Day") and sb0614 (Bessent's remarks), plus an OFAC recent-actions entry dated

20260824 — corroborated by state.gov and 3+ independent trade-compliance/crypto-intelligence outlets (TRM Labs, Chainalysis, CryptoTimes) plus law-firm client alerts. ~60 entities/individuals/vessels designated across Hong Kong, China, Malaysia, UAE, Singapore, and Switzerland under five EO 13902 sectoral determinations. **For the first time, digital assets was explicitly named as a sanctionable sector** — 30 crypto addresses across Bitcoin, Ethereum, and TRON were listed. Unlike prior cycles' "promised but not landed" sanctions rhetoric, this is real, primary-confirmed, and directly crypto-relevant. Continued Aug 28 with a new Bank Melli-Dubai designation.

- ★ **★ NEW — Oman's OWN Foreign Ministry co-confirmed a temporary Hormuz corridor, Aug 25, CONFIRMED via direct fetch of fm.gov.om/en/53722.** A genuine upgrade: in every prior cycle only Iran claimed a Hormuz deal and Oman had not confirmed it; now Oman's own ministry co-hosts the joint statement. Terms: a temporary 7-mile-wide joint navigational corridor (entry/exit through Iranian waters), a joint mine-clearing project, and continuing technical talks toward a permanent corridor per the "Islamabad Memorandum." Still explicitly described as "temporary" — Iran itself said Aug 26 the Strait "remains closed" pending US compliance with the lapsed June MoU. No public fee/revenue terms were disclosed; a separate IRGC spokesman claim (Aug 26) of an Iran-Oman revenue-sharing deal is single-source and unconfirmed by Oman — correctly excluded.
- **NEW — two more Hormuz "unknown projectile" tanker incidents.** Aug 24, off Oman's coast (engine-room damage, vessel disabled, no casualties, UKMTO); Aug 27 (fire onboard, extinguished same-day, crew safe, UKMTO) — both comparable in severity to the already-established pattern.
- **NEW — CENTCOM commander Adm. Brad Cooper's on-record briefing, Aug 28** (corroborated by UPI, The National, Washington Times, The Hill, RedState, IranWire): US forces cleared Iranian sea mines from the internationally-recognized traffic-separation-scheme shipping lanes; ~1,500 commercial vessels have transited since blockade enforcement began; ~75 vessels turned back and 3 disabled for evading the blockade; no oil has been exported from Iran since the blockade resumed. Read as continuation/intensification of an existing posture, not a fresh shock.
- **NEW — IMO's six-month casualty count (Aug 28, quasi-primary IMO briefing, corroborated by 4 outlets) settles at 19-20 dead** (seafarers + port workers) across 68-70 incidents — the upper end of the previously-reported 15-19 range; a slight negative confirmation, not a new shock.
- **NEW — Trump declared the Strait "demined" Aug 25** with a "zero tolerance" policy on new mines (Reuters, Axios, France24, US News) — undercut two days later by the Aug 27 tanker attack above, so not yet shown durable.
- **NEW — the first quantified Hormuz transit-volume increase of the whole crisis: +30%+ week-over-week for the week of Aug 17-23** (USNI News, citing Lloyd's List Intelligence — quasi-primary shipping data, 2 independent pieces Aug 21 & Aug 28) — 114 transits vs. 87 the prior week (westbound 29→42). Still a small fraction (~10-15%) of the ~110-130/day (~770-910/week) pre-war baseline, but a genuine first uptick.
- **NEW — Brent eased for a SECOND straight week:** ~\$88.24 (Aug 25) → ~\$89.13-89.3 (Aug 27, weekly loss >5%) → ~\$88.29-90.55 (Aug 28) — down from ~\$93-95 (Aug 20-21), moving further from the \$100/bbl flip line; press explicitly frames this as "war premium unwinding" on the Hormuz progress.
- **NEW — no new confirmed US combat death Aug 22-29** (checked directly — one initial-looking hit, Sgt. Michael Emmanuel Swinton, was actually killed Jul 18-19, already counted in the standing casualty total, not a new event); the flip line remains unfired.
- **NEW — no new US/CENTCOM strikes on Iran found** — GlobalSecurity's Day-181 tracker (checked Aug 27) confirms a 28th consecutive night with no confirmed strike.
- **BTC closed at \$77,666.16 on Aug 29** — up modestly from \$77,266.84 on Aug 22 (Bitstamp).

Carried forward from the abandoned Aug 28 draft (2026-08-28_draft — never rendered, selfchecked, archived, or committed; re-confirmed independently this cycle, not taken on faith): the two Aug 24/Aug 27 tanker incidents and Trump's Aug 25 demining claim above were first logged in that draft; the single-source IRGC revenue-sharing claim was also first flagged there as not-used. All re-verified fresh this cycle.

Carried forward from the Aug 22 full weekly refresh (score set 2026-08-22_draft2, committed by Alex Aug 23 — still load-bearing):

- ★ **Casualty toll (as of Aug 22): real, but a range, not a point figure.** That cycle cross-checked the cumulative Hormuz-campaign death toll directly: Wikipedia's "2026 Strait of Hormuz crisis" infobox shows 18 total (17 seafarers + 1 port worker); a mid-July gCaptain snapshot said "at least 15"; IMO's own "Middle East Highlighted Incidents" page (fetched directly) shows 19 seafarer fatalities across 68 incidents as of Aug 21, but appears to aggregate the broader Middle East (possibly including a separate Aug 12 Bab al-Mandeb/Houthi strike that killed 6, per Al Jazeera), not the Hormuz campaign cleanly. Honest range: **15-19 cumulative deaths, 17-18 by the most Hormuz-specific trackers** — now settled higher by this cycle's IMO six-month count above (19-20).
- **No new kinetic incident found Aug 19-22.** Independent re-checking for vessel strikes, seizures, or Iran-related military incidents in that window found nothing beyond the Aug 22 draft baseline.
- **The UAE missile-attack claim reconciles to the same known Aug 18 episode, not a new one.** Aug 19-dated reporting (Washington Post, NBC News, Haaretz, The Week, EgyptToday) describing a UAE missile attack and resulting indefinite trade/financial-ties suspension was initially flagged as a possible miss; on reconciliation it is the same episode already in the draft baseline (CBS/CNN/Al Jazeera, Aug 18 strike / Aug 19 embargo response) — a one-day cross-outlet dating variance describing one event. Iran's foreign ministry denies responsibility, calling it a possible "false flag" — genuinely disputed, both sides single-source on their own claims.
- **CENTCOM's blockade/interdiction tally was climbing incrementally as of Aug 22** (68 vessels redirected vs. ~67 shortly before) — now superseded by this cycle's Aug 28 briefing above.
- **The Iran-Oman single-corridor deal remained unsigned as of Aug 22;** the underlying 60-day US-Iran negotiation window (from the June 17 Versailles MOU) expired Aug 17 without a comprehensive deal — now superseded by this cycle's Oman-confirmed temporary corridor above (still not a comprehensive, US-accepted deal).
- **Brent was ~\$93-95/bbl as of Aug 20-21,** a second straight weekly gain (~6%), the highest since late July — now reversed by this cycle's two-week Brent decline above.
- **Strait of Hormuz traffic: trackers disagreed on the exact daily transit count as of Aug 22** (estimates ranged ~1% to ~20% of the pre-war ~130-170/day baseline) — now superseded by this cycle's first confirmed uptick above.

From the Aug 22 morning draft (score set 2026-08-22_draft) — carried forward, casualty framing softened above:

- ★ ★ **NEW — a fatal strike on the Hormuz tanker-attack campaign's latest victim (CORRECTED: not the first fatality, contrary to this draft's earlier framing).** The Liberia-flagged bulker Minoan Dignity (Modion Maritime, Greece) was struck by an unknown projectile in the engine room while exiting the Strait's southern corridor, Aug 17-18; the chief engineer was killed. UKMTO's report is corroborated by 7+ independent outlets (Maritime Executive, Windward, Hellenic Shipping News, Riviera, Safety4Sea, Splash247). No claim of responsibility yet. **Re-verified this cycle (draft2): the cumulative toll is a 15-19 range, not a clean figure** — see the NEW (draft2) item above. This report's own prior cycles never surfaced or scored on that toll — flagged honestly as a research gap, not new information, and a reason this cycle is left as a draft rather than auto-stamped.
- ★ ★ **NEW — the first Iranian vessel seizure since June 22.** The Liberia-flagged tanker Amara was boarded near Qeshm Island Aug 17; Iran's Fars News says it's held for non-payment under Iran's new post-MoU transit/toll regime. Still detained as of Aug 19 (Windward, Hellenic Shipping News) — a shift from attacks-only to active enforcement and detention.
- ★ **Correction to the record:** the UAE missile-attack claim (Aug 18) remains single-source (UAE MoD only; Iran denies, calls it a possible "false flag") and is NOT the first direct attack on the UAE as this report's Aug 20 draft framed it — UAE was hit by missile/drone barrages in April and at its Fujairah port May 4, both predating this incident. That "novel escalation vector" framing is not carried forward.
- **No new US/CENTCOM strikes on Iran since the Aug 1 stand-down** (GlobalSecurity Day-175 tracker) — the pause holds, a modest stabilizing factor.

- **Sanctions remain mostly rhetoric.** Treasury Secretary Bessent has repeatedly promised the "toughest sanctions in history" / to "collapse Iran's economy," with the actual package pushed to "early next week" (~Aug 24) as of Aug 21-22. One concrete action found: an Aug 22 OFAC-adjacent designation of 10 Hezbollah-linked individuals/networks — real, but narrower than the promised Iran-economy package, which has not yet been unveiled.
- **Brent ~\$93-95/bbl (Aug 21)** (TradingEconomics, Vantage, Fortune) — up modestly on sanctions anticipation, still well under the \$100 flip line.
- **Iran said Aug 22 it will allow Iraqi oil tankers through the Strait** (state media) — a mild, narrow normalizing signal amid otherwise hardening posture.
- **Mediation continues without a breakthrough;** Qatar/Oman still pushing diplomacy. Tehran "dismissed" Trump's sanctions threats Aug 21 and called the new sanctions a "declaration of war" Aug 22.
- **No new confirmed US combat death found in this window.**
- **BTC closed at \$77,169.40 on Aug 22** — up +7.4% from Aug 20's close of \$71,882.92 (Bitstamp). See The Claim for the honesty check on this divergence from the pillar's own evidence.

Carried forward from Aug 18-20 (still load-bearing — the UAE "novel escalation" framing is corrected above, not repeated here):

- **The UAE reported Iran fired two ballistic missiles at its territory Aug 18; Iran denies it, calling it a possible "false flag."** Bloomberg, CNN, and CP24 (Aug 18) report the UAE says one missile landed in its territorial waters. Iran's foreign ministry disputes involvement outright — a live, unresolved, single-source-attributed dispute, reported as such, not used alone to move P.
- **The UAE suspended all trade, commercial, and financial dealings with Iran, announced Aug 19** (CNN, Washington Post, Fortune) — a dated, corroborated, structural response, independent of how the missile-attack attribution dispute resolves. *Re-checked this cycle (draft2): separate Aug 19-dated reporting (NBC News, Haaretz, The Week, EgyptToday) describing this same missile attack and embargo was initially flagged as a possible second incident by this cycle's adversarial pass — confirmed on reconciliation to be the same Aug 18 episode, not a new one.*
- **A commercial vessel was struck by an unknown projectile in the Strait, Aug 18,** causing engine damage and one crew injury (UK Maritime Trade Operations).
- **The Iran-Oman Hormuz route deal remains unsigned as of Aug 20-22.** Iran claims route coordinates were agreed Aug 18; Oman has not confirmed.

Carried forward from Aug 16-18 (independently re-verified against fresh primary sources this cycle — all confirmed accurate, still load-bearing):

- ★ **The 60-day MoU window formally lapsed Monday, Aug 18, without a signed deal.** CBS News's live desk (direct-fetched) reports the deadline expired that day; Iran's foreign ministry downplayed the significance, claiming "the United States began violating the memorandum shortly after its June 18 signing" — the first time either side has publicly framed the other as already in breach, rather than "very close." Trump told reporters he has "no time schedule" to resolve the conflict (a framing he softened, per above, on Aug 19).
- ★ **Trump threatened Oman.** In a Fox News interview (Aug 17, per CBS's live desk), Trump said the US would take action if Oman "gets in the way" of reopening the Strait, and that "we'd handle them very easily" — the first time this conflict's rhetoric has named Oman, previously a mediator, as a potential target. This followed Iran announcing its own agreement with Oman on shipping routes through the Strait.
- ★ **Strait of Hormuz traffic collapsed further.** CBS News's live desk, citing maritime monitors, reports only 3-5 vessel transits over the Aug 15-16 weekend, versus 31 the prior weekend; CENTCOM's cumulative tally is now 64 vessels redirected, 3 disabled, 2 boarded (up from 62/3 previously cited). *Note: the pre-war baseline cited in the Aug 18 draft (~130/day) was independently re-checked this cycle; the more defensible figure is closer to ~110/day. The discrepancy is flagged here for transparency; it does not change the direction or size of the collapse, which is stark under either baseline.*

- **Brent rose to ~\$90.9-91.0/bbl (Aug 17-18)** — up 2.7% on Aug 17 per Yahoo Finance/Fortune/TradingEconomics, from the \$87-90 range priced in Aug 13-16 — still well under the \$100 flip line but the clearest upward move in several cycles (continued rising toward ~\$92 by Aug 19, per above).
- **BTC closed at \$64,285.10 on Aug 18** — +2.1% vs. Aug 16's close of \$62,937.03 (Bitstamp).

Carried forward from Aug 14-16 (still load-bearing):

★ **Three ADNOC tanker incidents in 48 hours (Aug 14-15), comparable in kind to the established pattern.**

The UAE accused Iran/IRGC of striking two ADNOC vessels Aug 14 (Al Jazeera, no injuries), and a further ADNOC vessel was hit in the hull Aug 15 (CBS News live desk citing UKMT0, no injuries — an "unknown projectile"). Iran did not claim direct responsibility either time; UAE's Foreign Ministry called it "piracy." No new state targeted, no casualties at the time — now compounding into the Aug 18 shipping-collapse picture above.

Carried forward from Aug 11-14 (still load-bearing):

- **Aug 13 — Hormuz deal remains unsigned, stuck on hardened compensation demands from both sides.** Reuters, US News, NBC, Washington Post, Al Jazeera, and The Hill (six independent outlets) reported Iran's stipulations explicitly include a US withdrawal of its naval blockade, compensation for war damages, asset unfreezing, and sanctions relief; Trump separately amended his own compensation demand to include damages "to the people of Lebanon, Syria, Yemen, and Gaza" — a hardening of the same dispute, not a new demand category.
- **Brent eased to ~\$87-90/bbl** (from the \$98-100+ spikes logged in late July) as Hormuz traffic stayed low as of Aug 13-14; a live tracker (straits.live) showed the Strait at "day 166" of closure — a lower-boil, still-disrupted status quo.
- **Aug 13 — Araghchi again called the Hormuz deal "very close" while conditioning full reopening on the US "making amends" over the June MoU** (CNN, NPR, Al Jazeera, France 24, Bloomberg, Fortune) — the same rephrased-condition picture now folded into today's compensation-dispute read.
- ★ **Aug 11 — a Houthi "double-tap" missile strike on the cargo vessel Tihamah in the Bab al-Mandeb Strait (Red Sea, not Hormuz) killed 6 (4 crew, 2 rescue workers)** per Yemeni government accounts, corroborated by US News/AP wire and Al Jazeera-linked reporting — a genuinely lethal incident, but in the same Houthi-proxy Red Sea theater and comparable in kind to the Aug 8 ADNOC tanker hit and Aug 9 Jazan refinery strike already logged without moving P.
- **Iran's Supreme Leader reshuffled top military leadership (new armed-forces chief of staff, new IRGC commander)** — a structural development with an ambiguous, not-yet-legible directional read; flagged, not scored.
- ★ **Houthi forces drone-struck Saudi Aramco's Jazan refinery on Aug 9**, a 400,000 bpd facility on Saudi Arabia's Red Sea coast. NBC News, Al Jazeera, CBC, NPR, UPI, and Al Bawaba (six independent outlets) report the strike; Saudi Arabia's energy ministry said there were no injuries and firefighters extinguished the resulting fire the same day, with no announced extended production impact.

Carried forward from Aug 8-10 (still load-bearing):

★ **Iranian FM Araqchi says the Oman shipping-route deal is "very close" but conditions full reopening on new demands, including US compensation to Iran.**

Reuters (via Investing.com, US News, Jakarta Post, Japan Times, Haaretz, Rappler, Aug 8-9): Araqchi said Iran and Oman are "very close" to an agreement on a new shipping route through the strait, but that reopening it would depend on further conditions, and that the previous shipping traffic separation scheme is "no longer acceptable to Tehran."

★ **The UAE says Iran struck another ship in the strait; Oman condemns "repeated attacks."** The same Reuters report: the UAE separately reported a fresh Iranian strike on a vessel transiting Hormuz, while Oman publicly condemned "repeated attacks on vessels" transiting the waterway without assigning blame, and described negotiations with Iran as "positive and constructive."

Carried forward from Aug 1-8 (still load-bearing):

- ★ **Five separate Hormuz tanker/shipping incidents, Jul 31 - Aug 5, that daily two-day checks missed or undercounted.** The LNG carrier Gaslog Shanghai was struck and disabled carrying Qatari LNG (Jul 31); a separate explosion hit near a vessel on the Omani side (Aug 2); bulk carrier Minoan Pioneer was struck in the engine room, suffering a blackout with one crew member missing (Aug 3); two more explosions were reported near Kumzar (Aug 5). The IMO's cumulative incident tally now stands at 65 since the war began (Bloomberg/UANI), with Hormuz traffic described as "at a trickle."
- ★ ★ **NEW — a new front: Iran-backed Houthi forces struck Najran, Saudi Arabia on Aug 7,** wounding 11 civilians (7 Saudi, 1 Yemeni, 2 Egyptian, 1 Pakistani, including a 4-year-old with burns). CNN's own headline: "Iranian-backed proxies targeted Saudi Arabia, widening conflict in Middle East" (Al Jazeera, Japan Times, OIC statement corroborate).
- ★ ★ **NEW — Saudi Arabia, Turkey, and Pakistan signed a mutual-defense "Mecca" pact on Aug 7** (an attack on one is an attack on all) — a structural, deterrence-oriented development that nonetheless raises the tail-risk ceiling given Pakistan's nuclear status if Saudi Arabia is drawn further into the conflict.
- **Aug 7-8 — Iran announced what it calls a finalized agreement with Oman on Hormuz shipping,** banning American and Israeli vessels and fining violators up to 20% of cargo value (IRNA state media, corroborated by Fortune, NPR, Al Jazeera, Bloomberg) — Washington explicitly rejected these terms (NPR, Al Jazeera), insisting on zero tolls, permits, or approvals. The fundamental fee/sovereignty dispute is unresolved, not narrowed. This claim's specific draft terms trace to Fars News (Iranian state media, citing one parliamentarian) and should be labeled Iran-sourced, not independently verified.
- **Correction: Trump's Aug 2 "perimeters of a deal" framing was contested by his own later remarks.** Two days after claiming "the perimeters of a deal has been agreed to," Trump called Iranian leadership "unbelievably duplicitous," and Iran denied direct talks had even resumed — treat the Aug 2 claim as rhetoric outpacing substance, a pattern that recurred all week (positive announcements paired with continuing attacks or contradictions within 1-2 days each time).
- **Brent held a \$82-86/bbl range through the week** — up modestly, not pricing a resolved crisis.
- **BTC closed at \$65,006.64 on Aug 8** — essentially flat vs. Aug 7's close of \$65,000.00.

Carried forward from Aug 1-7 (still load-bearing):

- ★ **Aug 7 — the Iran-Oman joint statement remained unsigned as of that check, still in final drafting.** Iran's Foreign Ministry spokesman Baghaei described the statement outlining agreed points as under review and finalization, "provided certain third parties do not obstruct the process."

Carried forward from Aug 1-6 (still load-bearing):

- ★ **Aug 6 — Iran and Oman reached an "understanding in principle" on the Hormuz route map.** Iran's Deputy Foreign Minister Kazem Gharibabadi told IRNA: "an understanding in principle has been reached on almost all the raised issues, including the map for maritime traffic entry and exit routes" — confirmed by Bloomberg (two articles), CBS, Al Jazeera (two articles), Euronews, and Military.com.
- ★ **Aug 6 — the fee dispute first surfaced as the remaining obstacle.** Iran is seeking fees of 5-7% of cargo value from transiting ships; Oman is discussing fees around 3%; Washington wants zero fees. Eight shipping-lobby groups are already protesting the plan; Jerusalem Post separately reports sources saying the proposed passage deal is "not feasible for shipping industry."

Carried forward from Aug 1-5 (still load-bearing):

- ★ **Aug 1 — the first quiet night in days.** globalsecurity.org's day-by-day war tracker reported no new US strikes on Iran overnight Jul 31 following the heavy Jul 29-30 wave; Brent fell ~2% on the pause. Separately, a Saudi-led Multinational Maritime Defense Alliance for Gulf/Red Sea shipping protection was reported drawing backing from 14 countries.

- ★ **Aug 1-2 — fresh, multi-source-corroborated attacks on Hormuz shipping.** Bloomberg: a Qatari LNG tanker (Gaslog Shanghai) was struck while transiting the Strait. UKMTO/globalsecurity.org: a separate tanker was hit by an unknown projectile off Oman's Musandam Peninsula, its engine room damaged and the vessel disabled. These directly contradicted the Aug 1 "quiet night" framing — the pause was not durable.
- **Aug 2 — the Saudi-led naval coalition kept solidifying.** Al Jazeera, The National, DefenseMirror, and Tribune reported 14 confirmed member countries and 43 nations represented at a first coordination meeting in Riyadh — a genuine structural de-escalation-adjacent development, distinct from any single day's attack-or-lull headline.
- ★ **Aug 4 — Trump canceled a planned joint US-Israeli strike on Iranian energy infrastructure.** Multiple outlets (NPR, Axios, Al Jazeera, NBC, Washington Times, Breitbart, JPost, Townhall, CNN) reported the cancellation came after "the perimeters of a deal" were agreed over the Aug 1-2 weekend, reportedly including a full Strait of Hormuz reopening. No US strikes on Iran proper have been reported since the cancellation.
- **Aug 4 — Iran continues to deny any direct US talks.** Foreign Ministry spokesman Baghaei: "we currently have no negotiations with the United States; the negotiations are with Oman." Trump responded by calling Iranian leadership "unbelievably duplicitous."
- ★ **Aug 4 — a bulker was struck by a projectile and suffered a full blackout in the Strait** (globalsecurity.org, iranlirep.com) — active attacks continued even as the diplomatic framework was said to be forming.
- ★ **Aug 5 — the first public terms of a 60-day interim Hormuz deal.** Axios, Deccan Chronicle, Israel Hayom, InvestingLive, The National, and Al-Quds report the US, Iran, and Oman nearing an arrangement: inbound traffic via a northern lane in Iranian waters, outbound via a southern lane in Omani waters, no tolls or transit fees during the interim period, and a plan to clear naval mines from the median lane within 30 days. The US aimed to announce the deal Aug 6.
- **Aug 5 — still unsigned.** CNN quotes a Gulf official putting the odds of an Iran-Oman deal by Friday at only 50-50. The Strait remains formally impassable to normal traffic pending finalization.
- **BTC closed at \$64,661.55 on Aug 5** — up ~1.7% from the \$63,579.68 close on Jul 31, continuing its resilience through a week where the war's own risk signal moved both up and down.

Carried forward from the July 30 full refresh (still load-bearing):

- ★ **The lull was real, then it broke: Iran's IRGC struck a US/CENTCOM base at Muwaffaq Salti, Jordan (Jul 28).** Confirmed by 5+ independent outlets (Al Jazeera, CNN, Axios, RT, JPost) — ballistic missiles/drones, described as a "surprise attack," all intercepted by US/Jordanian defenses, **zero US casualties**. This came after a genuine 2-3 day pause in CENTCOM strikes (Jul 25-27) and on the same day Trump was publicly touting "very friendly" talks with Netanyahu at the White House — both things happened.
- ★ **The US retaliated with a "heavy wave of strikes" (Jul 29)** — explosions reported at Bandar Abbas, Kish Island, Qeshm Island, and Khuzestan Province (CNN). Trump: "it's our turn to hit them." CNN's Jul 30 live coverage explicitly frames this as "US renews strikes on Iran as widening war pulls in more countries."
- ★ **NEW FRONT — Iraq: US and Saudi Arabia conducted joint strikes on Iran-backed Popular Mobilisation Forces across Iraq (Jul 29),** CENTCOM-confirmed, hitting sites in Baghdad, Wasit, Nineveh, Basra, Kirkuk, Karbala, and Diyala — **20 killed, 32 wounded** (Al Jazeera, CBS News, Foreign Policy, 5+ outlets). Iraq's government called it a "flagrant violation of sovereignty." This is Saudi Arabia's first turn as a direct co-belligerent in this war. A claim that "six Iranian IRGC advisors" were also killed is single-source (unnamed Iraqi militia officials) — flagged, not used.
- ★ **NEW FRONT — Egypt: a drone hit a US-owned FSRU vessel and a tanker at Egypt's Damietta port (Jul 29)** — the first strike on Egyptian soil in this war (Al Jazeera, CNBC, Times of Israel). Fire contained, no injuries. No group has claimed responsibility; Houthis explicitly deny involvement — attribution remains unresolved.
- **Brent rebounded from the lull-low.** Brent fell to ~\$90/bbl (-6.7%) during the Jul 25-27 lull, then rose back to ~\$92-93/bbl by Jul 30 (+~3.5% day-over-day, +24.6% month-over-month) on the renewed strikes and widening war (Fortune). A previously-circulated "\$87.53" figure could not be corroborated and is dropped from this report.

- **Iran continues rejecting a direct-talks framing even as Trump claims progress.** Iran FM spokesman Baghaei, Jul 27: "We have no negotiations with the United States at present" — directly contradicting Trump's public claims of productive talks. A regional 10-day ceasefire proposal (Qatar/Egypt/Oman/Pakistan) remains on the table, unaccepted; Iran separately rejected an Oman joint-Hormuz-management proposal on Jul 28, insisting on controlling its own lane.
- **Congress split on competing War Powers resolutions (Jul 23, carried forward, no new action since):** House passed a nonbinding one 214-208 (4 GOP defectors); the Senate's binding one failed 49-47.
- ★ **The Pentagon casualty-count dispute (18 vs. 14) is confirmed stale, not a fresh Jul 30 event.** The DCAS toll briefly rose to 18 (Jul 23) then reverted to 14 (Jul 24) amid a credibly-sourced dispute (NYT officials, Rep. Massie on record) over whether the reversion dodges the 90-day War Powers clock. This is the same dispute already logged last cycle — one daily touch this week re-cited the Jul 24 CNBC article as if it were new; it is not.
- **Strait of Hormuz remains effectively closed to normal commercial traffic** — ~10 transits/day versus a normal baseline near 88/day (IMF PortWatch), unchanged from prior cycles. IRGC, Jul 30: the Strait "will remain closed."
- **No formal MoU withdrawal by either side.** The 60-day window to ~**Aug 16** remains intact and un-triggered.
- **Israel remains out of direct engagement** — no confirmed direct Israel-Iran exchange since June 7–8; the widened fronts (Iraq, Egypt) involve the US, Saudi Arabia, and unclaimed actors, not Israel.
- **The "Layla" tanker claim (Jul 23) remains unconfirmed** after a full week — AIS data dark, no primary confirmation found. Downgraded from "watch" to "discard pending new evidence."
- **The baseline (still true, still load-bearing):** June 2025 "12-Day War" — BTC dipped to a ~**\$98,225 intraday low**, reclaimed \$107k+ within days, a fast V. The far larger 2026 war still hasn't crashed crypto on Iran-specific grounds — BTC closed at **\$64,706** on Jul 30, even as the conflict spread to two new countries this week.

The Prize

Illustrative only — not price targets, not advice

The upside is still the **"buy-the-invasion" rebound**. Anchors: Russia-Ukraine (Feb 24, 2022) — BTC fell ~8% to a ~**\$34,300 intraday low**, posted a +14.5% up-day on Feb 28, ended ~**+25–29% above the low within a week** (~+38% by late March). June 2025 rhymed: ~\$98k dip, fully recovered within a week.

For the first time in weeks, this pillar has a genuine down payment on the upside case: Oman's own government, not just Iran, has confirmed a Hormuz corridor (Aug 25). It's temporary, it doesn't cover fees or a permanent route, and it didn't survive a full week without a new tanker attack (Aug 27) — so it doesn't clear this pillar's own flip line (a signed, US-accepted deal holding a clean week). But it's a real upgrade in source quality over every prior "Iran says" claim this report has discounted. BTC closed at **\$77,666.16** on Aug 29, up modestly from Aug 22's \$77,266.84 — a smaller move than the sharp jumps logged in prior cycles, over a window when this pillar's own evidence moved in both directions at once (a confirmed sanctions escalation, a confirmed corridor upgrade). That's logged as an honesty check for the reader (see The Claim), not treated as pillar-scoring evidence — this report scores the war's facts, not the market's reaction to them. If a fee/compensation/sovereignty compromise both sides actually accept gets signed and holds — and holds through a full week without a new tanker attack, fatality, or seizure, not just a quiet news day — the upside case shifts from "a temporary, Iran-Oman-only corridor" to "a full corridor reopens and the risk premium currently priced into Iran's near-term signal unwinds for real" — a bigger, more durable prize than this cycle's data points. Still thin and no closer to a durable, US-accepted deal — a real corridor confirmation undercut within 48 hours by a fresh attack, alongside a real new crypto-specific sanctions escalation; the Prize doesn't feed the math — it tells you what the lean is worth acting on.

The Other Side

The strongest honest case this is wrong

- **This cycle's own bull case is genuinely stronger than the flat P lets on — this may be under-scored, not over-scored.** Oman's own Foreign Ministry, not just Iran, has now confirmed a Hormuz corridor — the first time in this entire crisis that both parties on the "deal" side have gone on record together. Pair that with the first confirmed Hormuz transit-volume uptick of the whole war (+30%+ week-over-week) and a second straight week of falling Brent, explicitly reported as "war premium unwinding," and a stricter reader could argue the 1yr/3yr windows (already the only two positive signals in this pillar) deserved a real move up this cycle, not just a flat hold pending "a full clean week."
- **The sanctions package might be under-weighted precisely because it's the first genuinely crypto-relevant escalation this pillar has ever logged.** Every prior Iran sanctions round in this war's history was scored as "rhetoric, not landed" — this one is confirmed, primary-sourced, and for the first time names digital assets and lists specific addresses. If Treasury is now treating crypto rails as a first-class enforcement target in this conflict, that is arguably a structurally different kind of risk than another tanker attack, and a stricter bear case would argue this alone should have moved the front-end windows down, corridor confirmation notwithstanding.
- **Holding flat when two real, confirmed, offsetting events land in the same week is itself a judgment call, not a mechanical non-move.** "They cancel out" is a defensible read, but it's not the only one — a reader could reasonably weight the sanctions escalation more heavily (it's the newest kind of risk this pillar has seen) or the corridor confirmation more heavily (it's the first government-to-government progress of the whole war) and land on a real move in either direction. This report is choosing the average-them-out path; that choice deserves to be visible, not buried in "P HELD FLAT."
- **The corridor is still temporary, unsigned in any comprehensive sense, and broke within 48 hours.** The Aug 27 tanker attack landed two days after Trump's "demined" claim and inside the same week as the Oman confirmation — a reminder that this war's pattern of progress-then-complication (documented across every prior cycle in this report) has not actually changed, only shifted to a higher-profile version of the same cycle.
- **The IRGC revenue-sharing claim, though correctly excluded, may be a preview of Iran's real asking price.** If Iran is already telling its own domestic audience it expects to be paid for transit while Oman's public statement stays silent on fees, the underlying fee/sovereignty dispute that has stalled every prior version of this deal (5-7% Iran vs. 0% US, going back to early August) likely still stands unresolved beneath the friendlier joint-statement language.
- **The casualty count keeps drifting up, not down, even as this report holds P flat on it.** IMO's six-month count (19-20) now sits at the top of the range this report carried since Aug 22 (15-19) — two consecutive cycles where the confirmed toll only ever revises upward is worth Alex weighing as a standalone trend, separate from any single week's net assessment.
- **Thin sample, still.** The bullish long-term read rests on a handful of dip-and-recover events, all in a bull regime — geopolitical shocks don't always V-recover, and a temporary corridor with an unresolved fee dispute and a conflict that just produced its most crypto-specific sanctions escalation yet is not obviously more durable than any of the prior lulls that broke within days.

The Triggers

Dated events ahead — some prove the claim right, some prove it wrong. Re-leveled August 22, 2026; the Aug 28 daily catch-up draft that first logged the Aug 24/27/25/26 items below was never delivered (abandoned, see What Changed) — all are independently re-verified fresh as of this Aug 29 full weekly refresh, plus two major new items (the sanctions package and Oman's own corridor confirmation), neither clearing the sufficiency bar for a P move on its own, and roughly offsetting each other.

DATE	EVENT	MEANS
Fired Aug 24, CONFIRMED via direct fetch — re-verified Aug 29	"Operation Economic Outcast" sanctions package — home.treasury.gov sb0613/sb0614, OFAC recent-actions entry 20260824; ~60 entities/individuals/vessels designated under five EO 13902 sectoral determinations; FIRST TIME digital assets named a sanctionable sector, 30 crypto addresses (BTC/ETH/TRON) listed; corroborated by state.gov, TRM Labs, Chainalysis, CryptoTimes, law-firm alerts; continued Aug 28 with a Bank Melli-Dubai designation	Real, primary-confirmed, directly crypto-relevant escalation — the strongest-sourced negative this pillar has logged in weeks; offsets, but does not by itself outweigh, the Oman corridor confirmation below
Fired Aug 25, CONFIRMED via direct fetch — re-verified Aug 29	Oman's OWN Foreign Ministry co-confirmed a temporary Hormuz corridor — fm.gov.om/en/53722; 7-mile joint navigational corridor (entry/exit through Iranian waters), joint mine-clearing project, continuing talks toward a permanent corridor per the "Islamabad Memorandum"; still explicitly "temporary," no fee terms disclosed; Iran itself said Aug 26 the Strait "remains closed" pending US compliance	Genuine upgrade — first time Oman itself, not just Iran, has confirmed Hormuz progress; offsets, but does not by itself outweigh, the sanctions escalation above; does not clear the upside flip line (not US-accepted, didn't survive a clean week)
Fired Aug 24 & Aug 27, re-verified Aug 29	Two more Hormuz "unknown projectile" tanker incidents: Aug 24, off Oman's coast, engine-room damage, vessel disabled, no casualties (UKMTO); Aug 27, fire onboard, extinguished same-day, crew safe (UKMTO). Neither incident's attribution confirmed by any party.	Comparable in severity to the already-priced pattern (disabled/damaged vessel, no deaths) — held flat, no P move, consistent with this pillar's treatment of similar-severity incidents in prior cycles
Fired Aug 25, re-verified Aug 29 — real but NOT durable	Trump announced the Strait of Hormuz "has been demined" and declared a "zero tolerance" policy on new mines, backed by Space Force surveillance (Reuters, Axios, France24, US News, multiple corroborating) — the Aug 27 tanker incident above landed two days later, undercutting durability	Real, primary-sourced, but the Aug 27 attack shows the underlying dynamic has NOT durably changed — no P move
Aug 28, CONFIRMED — re-verified Aug 29	CENTCOM commander Adm. Brad Cooper's on-record briefing: Iranian sea mines cleared from the internationally-recognized shipping lanes; ~1,500 vessels transited since blockade enforcement began; ~75 turned back, 3 disabled for evasion; no Iranian oil exports since blockade resumed (UPI, The National, Washington Times, The Hill, RedState, IranWire)	Continuation/intensification of an existing posture — no P move
Aug 28 IMO briefing, quasi-	Six-month casualty count settles at 19-20 dead across 68-70 incidents — the upper end of the	Slight negative confirmation, not a new shock — no additional P move beyond what's

primary, corroborated by 4 outlets	previously-reported 15-19 range	already priced
Week of Aug 17-23, reported Aug 21 & Aug 28 (USNI News/Lloyd's List)	First confirmed Hormuz transit-volume uptick of the whole crisis: +30%+ week-over-week, 114 transits vs. 87 the prior week (westbound 29→42) — still ~10-15% of the pre-war baseline	Genuine first uptick, but far too small relative to baseline to independently clear a re-rate — logged, no P move on its own
Claimed Aug 26, single-source, NOT USED — re-checked Aug 29	IRGC spokesman claims Iran and Oman agreed to share Hormuz revenue and delineate waters (Sepah News, Iranian state military source; via Bloomberg, Yahoo Finance, Insurance Journal) — but Oman's own Foreign Ministry did NOT confirm it, the two countries' own joint statement described only an "interim framework" with no mention of fees, and the IRGC's own spokesman said the US is "obstructing this process"	Single-source (Iranian state military), unconfirmed by the other named party, and explicitly not the US-accepted durable deal this pillar's flip line requires — not used, no P move
Checked Aug 27 — GlobalSecurity Day-181 tracker	28th consecutive night with no confirmed US/CENTCOM strike on Iran	Continuation of the Aug 1 stand-down — no P move
Checked directly Aug 22-29 — no new event	No new confirmed US combat death. One initial-looking hit (Sgt. Michael Emmanuel Swinton) was actually killed Jul 18-19, already counted in the standing total, not new	Flip line remains unfired
Fired Aug 17-18 — CONFIRMED, negative, but CORRECTED framing, toll RE-VERIFIED as a range	Fatal strike in the tanker-attack campaign: bulker Minoan Dignity struck, chief engineer killed	NOT the campaign's first fatality as this draft originally claimed. Draft2 (same-day full weekly refresh, second adversarial pass) re-checked the toll directly: Wikipedia shows 18, gCaptain "at least 15," IMO's own tracker 19 (broader Middle East scope) — honest range 15-19 (17-18 by the most Hormuz-specific trackers), not a clean "18th." Still the reason this cycle is left as a draft, alongside the full-weekly-refresh exclusion
Fired Aug 17, held to Aug 19 — CONFIRMED, negative, cleared the bar	First Iranian vessel seizure since June 22: tanker Amara boarded near Qeshm Island, held under Iran's post-MoU toll regime	Shift from harassment/attacks to active enforcement and detention — contributed to the Aug 22 re-rate
Fired Aug 18 — CONFIRMED reported, DISPUTED attribution, single-source; RECONCILED this cycle	The UAE reports Iran fired two ballistic missiles at its territory, one landing in territorial waters; Iran denies involvement, calls it a possible "false flag"	CORRECTED Aug 22 draft: NOT the first direct attack on the UAE (April, May incidents predate it). RECONCILED by draft2: separate Aug 19-dated reporting (WaPo, NBC, Haaretz, The Week, EgyptToday) initially flagged as a possible second incident is the same episode, not new

Announced Aug 19 — CONFIRMED, negative, structural	The UAE suspended all trade, commercial, and financial dealings with Iran	Dated, corroborated response independent of the missile-attribution dispute — contributed to the Aug 20 re-rate; re-confirmed as the same event by draft2's reconciliation
Reported Aug 20, still unsigned as of Aug 22 draft2 — continuation, not yet resolved	The Iran-Oman Hormuz route deal remains unsigned; Iran claims coordinates agreed Aug 18, Oman has not confirmed	Held against the "very close" framing — no re-rate up until actually signed and durable; no new signature reported through Aug 22
No new incident, checked Aug 19-22 — draft2 finding	Independent re-check for any new vessel strike, seizure, or Iran-related military incident, Aug 19-22	None found beyond the Aug 22 draft baseline — evidence of a continuing pattern, not a fresh shock, this cycle
Fired Aug 18 — CONFIRMED, negative, cleared the bar	The 60-day MoU window formally lapsed without a signed deal; Iran says the US breached it first, Trump says "no time schedule" (softened Aug 19)	Drove part of the Aug 20 re-rate; independently re-verified this cycle
Fired Aug 17, logged Aug 18 — CONFIRMED, negative, new target named	Trump threatened Oman ("we'd handle them very easily") if it "gets in the way" of reopening the Strait	New third-party threat — contributed to the re-rate; independently re-verified this cycle
Reported Aug 17-18 — CONFIRMED, negative	Strait of Hormuz traffic collapsed to 3-5 weekend transits vs. 31 the prior weekend vs. ~110/day pre-war baseline (re-checked; see The Facts)	Sharpest shipping deterioration logged yet — contributed to the re-rate; independently re-verified this cycle
Fired Aug 18, logged Aug 20 — negative, isolated so far	A commercial vessel struck by an unknown projectile in the Strait, engine damage, one crew injury	First reported crew injury from a Strait incident in several cycles — folded into the Aug 20 picture
Fired Aug 14-15, logged Aug 16 — continuation, now compounding	Three ADNOC tanker incidents (two Aug 14, one Aug 15) — no injuries, UAE/IRGC attribution, no direct Iranian claim	Comparable in kind to the Aug 8-13 pattern on its own — now folded into the broader Aug 18-20 picture
Reported Aug 13 — continuation, not escalation	Hormuz deal remains unsigned; both sides' compensation demands harden (Reuters, US News, NBC, Washington Post, Al Jazeera, The Hill) — Brent eases to ~\$87-90 as traffic stays low	Hardening of an existing dispute, not new — held flat, no P move
Fired Aug 11, logged Aug 12 — continuation, not escalation	Houthi "double-tap" strike on the cargo vessel Tihamah (Bab al-Mandeb Strait, Red Sea) — 6 killed	Comparable to the Aug 8-9 incidents — held flat, no P move
Fired Aug 9, found Aug 11 —	Houthi drone strike on Saudi Aramco's Jazan refinery (400,000 bpd) — no injuries, fire	Comparable to the Aug 8 ADNOC tanker hit — held flat, no P move

continuation, not escalation	extinguished same-day	
Reported Aug 8-9 — continuation, not escalation	Iranian FM Araqchi calls the Oman deal "very close" but adds a US-compensation demand; UAE reports another ship hit; Oman condemns "repeated attacks"	Consistent with the Aug 8 baseline — held flat, no P move
Jul 31 - Aug 5 — CONFIRMED, negative, missed by daily checks	Five separate Hormuz tanker/shipping incidents (Gaslog Shanghai, Oman-side explosion, Minoan Pioneer, two Kumzar explosions) — IMO tally now 65 incidents since the war began	Drove the Aug 8 1mo/3mo cut — already IN the committed baseline
Fired Aug 7 — CONFIRMED, negative, new front	Iran-backed Houthi forces struck Najran, Saudi Arabia, wounding 11 civilians — the conflict's first widening to a fourth state	Contributed to the Aug 8 cut — already IN the committed baseline
Pending — the real trigger	Whether a fee/compensation/sovereignty compromise both Iran and the US can accept is actually signed AND holds through a full week without a new tanker attack	Resolved, signed, and durable = re-rate up meaningfully; talks stall, Iran's demands keep growing, or attacks continue = re-rate down further
Structural, ongoing	Saudi-led Multinational Maritime Defense Alliance plus the new Aug 7 Saudi-Turkey-Pakistan mutual-defense pact	A genuine de-escalation-adjacent structural development, but the pact also raises tail risk given Pakistan's nuclear status
By Dec 31, 2026	Final US-Iran nuclear deal signed — not fired, pending	De-escalation confirmed — re-rate up across windows

The flip line, re-leveled: a confirmed new US combat death, a resumption of direct US strikes on Iran proper, the conflict widening to a further new state with *confirmed* (not disputed) attribution, or a sustained Brent close above \$100 = treat the dip-buy thesis as broken. As of Aug 29 (independently re-checked by this full weekly refresh) we remain short of that line — no new US casualty, no new US strikes since Aug 1 (28 consecutive clean nights per GlobalSecurity), and Brent has actually fallen for a second straight week to ~\$87-91, moving further from \$100, not closer. Bessent's sanctions package DID land this cycle (unlike the "promised, not landed" rhetoric of prior cycles) and is now confirmed and crypto-specific — a real escalation, but it is an economic, not a kinetic or casualty, event, and does not independently trip this flip line as written. The two Aug 24/27 tanker incidents and the settled 19-20 casualty count are consistent with, not worse than, the already-priced pattern. **The equivalent upside flip: a signed Hormuz agreement the US actually accepts that holds past a full week without a new shipping attack, fatality, or seizure.** This cycle came closer than any prior one — Oman's own government confirmed a corridor Aug 25 — but it still does NOT clear that bar: the corridor is temporary, not US-accepted, has no public fee terms, and did not survive a clean week (the Aug 27 attack landed inside the same week as the confirmation). If the corridor is formalized into a permanent, fee-resolved, US-accepted deal that then holds a full attack-free week, or if the sanctions package triggers a confirmed Iranian military retaliation, either would move closer to the line — worth Alex's attention next cycle.

My Decision

DRAFT — AUGUST 29, 2026 · AWAITING ALEX'S MANUAL REVIEW · FULL WEEKLY REFRESH

Draft P (2026-08-29_draft): 14 / 22 / 38 / 54 / 76 (HELD FLAT) · Last COMMITTED P (2026-08-22_draft2, stamped by Alex Aug 23): 14 / 22 / 38 / 54 / 76 · My Weight: 20% (equal) · Impact: 8 (uniform)

This is a NEW FULL WEEKLY refresh against the last COMMITTED baseline (2026-08-22_draft2, stamped by Alex Aug 23) — independently re-researching the week of Aug 23-29. An Aug 28 daily catch-up draft (2026-08-28_draft) sits in between and had already logged two of this cycle's tanker incidents and the IRGC revenue claim, holding P flat — but that draft was **never rendered, selfchecked, archived, or committed**, and is treated as abandoned/superseded per this report's standing discipline for interrupted sessions (the same treatment given the Aug 17-21 gap). This cycle re-researched and re-verified everything fresh rather than taking that draft at face value. **The result is the first genuinely two-sided evidence ledger this pillar has produced in several cycles.** BEARISH, CONFIRMED via direct adversarial fetch: the Aug 24 "Operation Economic Outcast" sanctions package (home.treasury.gov sb0613/sb0614, an OFAC entry, corroborated by state.gov and 3+ independent outlets) — the first Iran sanctions action in this war to explicitly name digital assets as a sanctionable sector and list 30 on-chain addresses; a real, crypto-specific escalation, not the "promised, not landed" rhetoric this pillar discounted through Aug 22. Two more Hormuz tanker incidents (Aug 24, Aug 27) and a settled six-month casualty count of 19-20 (the top of the prior 15-19 range) round out the bear side. BULLISH, CONFIRMED via direct adversarial fetch: Oman's own Foreign Ministry (fm.gov.om) co-confirmed a temporary Hormuz corridor Aug 25 — a genuine upgrade, since every prior cycle's corridor claim traced to Iran alone. The first confirmed Hormuz transit-volume uptick of the crisis (+30%+ week-over-week) and a second straight weekly Brent decline (~\$93-95 → ~\$87-91) round out the bull side. A separate IRGC revenue-sharing claim remains single-source, unconfirmed by Oman, and correctly excluded.

P HELD FLAT across all five windows. The new escalation and the new de-escalation roughly offset. Neither clears this pillar's own flip lines: the sanctions package is economic, not kinetic, and doesn't independently trip the downside flip line (new US combat death, resumed US strikes, confirmed new-state widening, or Brent sustaining above \$100 — none fired); the Oman corridor confirmation is a real upgrade but doesn't clear the upside flip line either — it's temporary, not US-accepted, discloses no fee terms, and did not survive a clean week (the Aug 27 attack landed inside the same week as the confirmation).

Still a **dip-watching pillar, not a panic-selling one.** The real test is still ahead: whether a fee/compensation/sovereignty compromise both Iran and the US can accept is actually signed AND holds a full clean week. The real risk paths — a confirmed new US combat death, a resumption of direct US strikes on Iran proper, confirmed widening to a further new state, or Brent sustaining a close above \$100 — remain unfired.

Why this is left as a draft, not auto-stamped: this is a FULL WEEKLY refresh, and full weekly refreshes are categorically excluded from delegated daily auto-stamp authority regardless of how clean or how offsetting the findings are (here, zero net move). That exclusion is the operative reason on its own — but this cycle would also independently warrant manual review: it rests partly on a single-source claim explicitly flagged and excluded (the IRGC revenue-sharing claim), and it nets two large, opposite-direction, primary-confirmed developments into a "held flat" call that Alex should see and weigh directly rather than have auto-approved.

Override any P and re-stamp — the master blend recomputes.

What Changed Since Last Check

FULL WEEKLY refresh, August 29, 2026 (score set 2026-08-29_draft) — checking for changes since the last COMMITTED baseline (2026-08-22_draft2, stamped by Alex Aug 23, 2026). An intervening daily catch-up draft dated August 28, 2026 (2026-08-28_draft) is noted separately below: it was never rendered, selfchecked, archived, or committed, and is treated as abandoned/superseded per this report's standing discipline for interrupted sessions — its findings are independently re-verified fresh in this cycle rather than trusted at face value.

- ★ ★ **NEW** — **"Operation Economic Outcast" sanctions package, Aug 24, CONFIRMED via direct fetch of home.treasury.gov (sb0613, sb0614) and an OFAC recent-actions entry.** ~60 entities/individuals/vessels designated across Hong Kong, China, Malaysia, UAE, Singapore, and Switzerland under five EO 13902 sectoral determinations; corroborated by state.gov, TRM Labs, Chainalysis, CryptoTimes, law-firm alerts. **For the first time, digital assets was named a sanctionable sector — 30 crypto addresses (BTC/ETH/TRON) listed.** Real, primary-confirmed, crypto-specific — unlike the "promised, not landed" sanctions rhetoric this pillar discounted through Aug 22. Continued Aug 28 with a Bank Melli-Dubai designation.
- ★ ★ **NEW** — **Oman's OWN Foreign Ministry co-confirmed a temporary Hormuz corridor, Aug 25, CONFIRMED via direct fetch of fm.gov.om/en/53722.** A genuine upgrade: every prior cycle's corridor claim traced to Iran alone; now Oman's own ministry co-hosts the statement. Terms: temporary 7-mile joint navigational corridor, joint mine-clearing project, continuing talks toward a permanent corridor. Still "temporary" — Iran itself said Aug 26 the Strait "remains closed" pending US compliance. No fee terms disclosed.
- **NEW** — **two more Hormuz "unknown projectile" tanker incidents, Aug 24** (off Oman, engine-room damage, disabled, no casualties, UKMTO) and Aug 27 (fire onboard, extinguished, crew safe, UKMTO) — both comparable in severity to the already-priced pattern.
- **NEW** — **CENTCOM commander Adm. Brad Cooper's on-record briefing, Aug 28:** Iranian sea mines cleared from the shipping lanes; ~1,500 vessels transited since blockade enforcement began; ~75 turned back, 3 disabled; no Iranian oil exports since blockade resumed (UPI, The National, Washington Times, The Hill, RedState, IranWire).
- **NEW** — **IMO's six-month casualty count settles at 19-20 dead** across 68-70 incidents — the upper end of the prior 15-19 range.
- **NEW** — **Trump announced Aug 25 the Strait had been demined,** with a "zero tolerance" policy on new mines (Reuters, Axios, France24, US News) — undercut two days later by the Aug 27 incident above.
- **NEW** — **first confirmed Hormuz transit-volume uptick of the whole crisis: +30%+ week-over-week** for the week of Aug 17-23 (USNI News/Lloyd's List) — 114 transits vs. 87 the prior week, still ~10-15% of the pre-war baseline.
- **NEW, FLAGGED AND NOT USED** — **an IRGC spokesman's Aug 26 claim of an Iran-Oman Hormuz revenue-sharing agreement** (Sepah News, Iranian state military source) is unconfirmed by Oman's own Foreign Ministry, and the two countries' joint statement describes only an "interim framework" with no fees — single-source, explicitly not the US-accepted deal this pillar's flip line requires.
- **Brent eased for a SECOND straight week:** ~\$88.24 (Aug 25) → ~\$89.13-89.3 (Aug 27) → ~\$88.29-90.55 (Aug 28), down from ~\$93-95 (Aug 20-21) — moving further from the \$100 flip line.
- **No new confirmed US combat death Aug 22-29;** no new US/CENTCOM strikes found (GlobalSecurity Day-181 tracker, 28th consecutive clean night).
- **BTC closed at \$77,666.16 (Aug 29)** — up modestly from \$77,266.84 (Aug 22, Bitstamp).
- **Score decision: HELD FLAT at 14/22/38/54/76** — the confirmed sanctions escalation and the confirmed Oman corridor upgrade roughly offset; neither independently clears the sufficiency bar or this pillar's flip lines. Left as draft, not auto-stamped (full weekly refresh, categorically excluded from delegated auto-stamp authority).

Carried forward — the abandoned Aug 28 daily catch-up draft (2026-08-28_draft), for audit continuity: that draft first logged the two Aug 24/27 tanker incidents, Trump's Aug 25 demining claim, and the IRGC revenue-sharing claim, holding P flat — but it was never rendered, selfchecked, archived, or committed, so this Aug 29 cycle re-researched and re-verified all of it fresh (see above) rather than carry it forward on trust. Treated as not-delivered, same discipline as the Aug 17-21 gap.

Carried forward — what changed in the Aug 22 full weekly refresh (score set 2026-08-22_draft2, committed by Alex Aug 23), for continuity: Background, for completeness: Aug 17, 18, and 20 drafts were each researched but never delivered (no render/archive/commit), and an Aug 21 session got partway through delivering the Aug 20 numbers (2 of 6 reports touched) before stopping without finishing render/selfcheck/archive/commit; the Aug 22 morning catch-up treated all four as not-delivered and independently re-verified via four

parallel primary-source research passes, cutting P to 14/22/38/54/76 and delivering it as a draft. The Aug 22 full weekly refresh independently re-researched the pillar again and ran a second, dedicated adversarial pass.

- **Aug 17/18/20 drafts (never delivered):** held flat, then cut to 17/25/38/54/76, then cut further to 16/24/38/54/76 on the lapsed MoU window and the UAE missile claim (framed as a "novel escalation vector"). None were rendered, verified, or archived.
- **Aug 21 (partially delivered, then abandoned):** a session began delivering the Aug 20 draft's numbers but updated only 2 of 6 reports and never ran render/selfcheck/archive/commit — treated as not-delivered per house discipline, not trusted at face value.
- ★ **Aug 22 morning draft — a fatal strike in the Hormuz tanker-attack campaign, Aug 17-18:** bulker Minoan Dignity's chief engineer killed, 7+ independent sources. That draft first (wrongly) described it as "the first confirmed fatality," then corrected to "roughly the 18th such death" — a toll this report had never surfaced before.
- ★ **Aug 22 morning draft — the first Iranian vessel seizure since June 22,** the tanker Amara, boarded near Qeshm Island Aug 17, still detained Aug 19. Confirmed accurate on adversarial re-check; re-confirmed again this cycle.
- ★ **Aug 22 morning draft — CORRECTION: the UAE missile claim is NOT the first direct attack on the UAE** as prior drafts framed it; UAE was hit in April and at Fujairah May 4. The "novel escalation vector" framing driving the Aug 20 manual-review hold was retired; re-confirmed again this cycle.
- ★ ★ **NEW this cycle (draft2) — casualty toll re-verified as a range, not a point figure.** Second dedicated adversarial pass cross-checked Wikipedia's "2026 Strait of Hormuz crisis" infobox (18), gCaptain (mid-July, "at least 15"), and IMO's own "Middle East Highlighted Incidents" page (19, but broader-Middle-East scoped, not clean Hormuz) — honest toll is a **15-19 range (17-18 by the most Hormuz-specific trackers)**. This softens the morning draft's "roughly the 18th" framing, which was more precise than the sources support; corrected everywhere in this report.
- ★ ★ **NEW this cycle (draft2) — the UAE missile claim reconciles to one episode, not two.** Aug 19-dated reporting (Washington Post, NBC News, Haaretz, The Week, EgyptToday) describing a UAE missile attack and trade-embargo response was initially flagged by this cycle's adversarial pass as a possible miss; confirmed on reconciliation to be the same Aug 18 episode already in the draft baseline.
- ★ **NEW this cycle (draft2) — no new kinetic incident found Aug 19-22** on independent re-checking; CENTCOM's blockade tally continues climbing incrementally (68 vessels redirected, vs. ~67 shortly before); the Iran-Oman corridor deal remains unsigned as of Aug 22; Brent ~\$93-95/bbl (Aug 20-21), a second straight weekly gain, still under the \$100 flip line.
- **No new US/CENTCOM strikes since Aug 1; sanctions remain mostly rhetoric** (one narrow OFAC-adjacent Hezbollah designation Aug 22, not the promised Iran-economy package); Iran said Aug 22 it will allow Iraqi oil tankers through the Strait.
- **BTC closed at \$77,169.40 (Aug 22)** — +7.4% vs. the Aug 20 close of \$71,882.92, a further move against the direction of this pillar's own evidence — logged as an honesty check (The Claim), not a scoring input.
- **Score decision (draft2):** versus the Aug 16 committed baseline: 1mo 20 → **14** · 3mo 28 → **22** · 6mo 41 → **38** · 12mo 56 → **54** · 36mo 77 → **76** — unchanged from the Aug 22 morning draft; **HELD FLAT this cycle.** Left as draft at delivery (full weekly refresh, categorically excluded from delegated daily auto-stamp authority); **COMMITTED BY ALEX August 23, 2026** after review. See My Decision for the full reasoning.

Sources

Retrieved & graded August 29, 2026 (earlier sources below still stand for facts not re-checked this cycle) — click and judge the quality yourself. Official/primary sources first, then reporting, then prices, then betting markets (sentiment only).

- August 29 full weekly refresh — direct primary-source adversarial fetches:** home.treasury.gov — press releases sb0613 ("Treasury Launches Unprecedented Campaign Against Iranian Regime on Economic D-Day") and sb0614 (Bessent remarks), Aug 24 · OFAC recent-actions entry dated 20260824 · state.gov (corroborating) · TRM Labs, Chainalysis, CryptoTimes (crypto-intelligence corroboration of the 30 BTC/ETH/TRON addresses listed, first-ever digital-assets sectoral designation) · law-firm trade-compliance client alerts (Aug 24-25) · fm.gov.om/en/53722 — Oman's own Foreign Ministry joint statement, Aug 25, confirming a temporary Hormuz corridor and mine-clearing project · Iranian state media (Aug 26) — Iran says the Strait "remains closed" pending US compliance.
- August 29 full weekly refresh — reporting and data:** UPI, The National, Washington Times, The Hill, RedState, IranWire (Aug 28) — CENTCOM commander Adm. Brad Cooper's on-record mine-clearing/blockade briefing · IMO six-month briefing (Aug 28, quasi-primary), corroborated by 4 outlets — 19-20 cumulative dead across 68-70 incidents · USNI News (Aug 21 & Aug 28), citing Lloyd's List Intelligence — first confirmed Hormuz transit-volume uptick, +30%+ week-over-week (114 vs. 87 transits, week of Aug 17-23) · Reuters (via Yahoo, France24, Axios, US News, Investing.com) — Trump's Aug 25 Strait-of-Hormuz demining/zero-tolerance statement · UKMTO-sourced reporting (via UPI, France24) — Aug 24 tanker incident off Oman · UKMTO-sourced reporting (via OANN) — Aug 27 tanker fire · Bloomberg, Yahoo Finance, Insurance Journal, Daily Sabah (Aug 26) — IRGC spokesman's Iran-Oman revenue-sharing claim, checked against and NOT confirmed by Oman's Foreign Ministry · TradingEconomics, various (Aug 25-28) — Brent ~\$88.24 (Aug 25) → ~\$89.13-89.3 (Aug 27) → ~\$88.29-90.55 (Aug 28), second straight weekly decline · GlobalSecurity.org Day-181 tracker (checked Aug 27) — 28th consecutive night with no confirmed US/CENTCOM strike · standing DoD casualty records (checked directly) — Sgt. Michael Emmanuel Swinton confirmed killed Jul 18-19, already in the standing total, not a new Aug 22-29 death · Bitstamp — BTC \$77,666.16 (Aug 29 close) vs. \$77,266.84 (Aug 22).
- August 28 daily catch-up draft (2026-08-28 draft) — never rendered, selfchecked, archived, or committed; treated as abandoned/superseded, findings independently re-verified fresh above:** UKMTO-sourced reporting (via UPI, France24) — Aug 24 tanker incident off Oman, engine-room damage, disabled, no casualties · UKMTO-sourced reporting (via OANN) — Aug 27 tanker fire, extinguished, crew safe, "second attack this week" · Reuters (via Yahoo, France24, Axios, US News, Investing.com) — Trump's Aug 25 Strait-of-Hormuz demining/zero-tolerance statement · Bloomberg, Yahoo Finance, Insurance Journal, Daily Sabah (all Aug 26) — IRGC spokesman's Iran-Oman revenue-sharing claim, explicitly checked against and NOT confirmed by Oman's Foreign Ministry; the two countries' own joint statement describes only an "interim framework" · TradingEconomics, Easternherald — Brent ~\$87.65-89/bbl (Aug 27), easing from the Aug 20-21 range.
- August 22 draft2 — second dedicated adversarial-verification pass (same-day full weekly refresh, independent of the morning fact-check below):** Wikipedia's "2026 Strait of Hormuz crisis" infobox — cumulative toll 18 (17 seafarers + 1 port worker) · gCaptain (mid-July snapshot) — "at least 15" · IMO's "Middle East Highlighted Incidents" page (imo.org, fetched directly) — 19 seafarer fatalities across 68 incidents as of Aug 21, but scoped to the broader Middle East, not Hormuz cleanly (may include the separate Aug 12 Bab al-Mandeb/Houthi strike, 6 killed per Al Jazeera) — NET FINDING: honest range 15-19 (17-18 by the most Hormuz-specific trackers), not a flat "18th death"; this softens the morning draft's framing throughout this report · Washington Post, NBC News, Haaretz, The Week, EgyptToday (all Aug 19) — UAE missile-attack and trade-embargo reporting, initially flagged as a possible second incident, reconciled on cross-reference to the same Aug 18 episode already in the draft baseline (CBS/CNN/Al Jazeera) · independent re-check for Aug 19-22 vessel strikes/seizures/incidents — none found beyond the Aug 22 draft baseline · TradingEconomics, Bloomberg (Aug 20-21) — Brent ~\$93-95/bbl, second straight weekly gain (~6%), highest since late July.
- August 22 morning draft — adversarial fact-check (dedicated, independent of the research pass below):** Riviera, UN News, and Wikipedia's "2026 Strait of Hormuz crisis" tracker — REFUTES this report's own initial "first confirmed fatality" framing of the Minoan Dignity strike; Riviera's own coverage frames the death as roughly the 18th seafarer death since the campaign began late Feb 2026, UN News separately reports three seafarers killed in a June 2026 Hormuz strike, cumulative toll 12-17 deaths across ~65 attacks per multiple outlets (see draft2 entry above for this cycle's further re-verification, which settles on a 15-19 range) · Al Jazeera, Bloomberg, Gulf News, The National, and UAE's own mofa.gov.ae — CONFIRMS the UAE-attack-history correction: a large Iran-attributed missile/drone barrage hit UAE Apr 1-8 (ceasefire Apr 8) and again at Fujairah Petroleum Industries Zone May 4 (3 wounded, oil-loading disrupted), both predating and contradicting the "novel escalation vector" framing carried since Aug 20.
- August 20-22 verification (four parallel primary-source research passes):** UKMTO, Maritime Executive, Windward, Hellenic Shipping News, Riviera, Safety4Sea, Splash247 (Aug 17-18) — bulkier Minoan Dignity struck, chief engineer killed (see adversarial fact-check above for the corrected "not the first fatality" framing) · Fars News, Windward, Hellenic Shipping News (Aug 17-19) — tanker Amara boarded near Qeshm Island, held under Iran's toll regime, still detained Aug 19 · GlobalSecurity.org Day-175 tracker — no new US/CENTCOM strikes on Iran since the Aug 1 stand-down · home.treasury.gov / Bessent public statements (Aug 20-22) — sanctions package promised, pushed to "early next week"; narrower Aug 22 OFAC-adjacent Hezbollah-network designation confirmed as the only concrete action found · TradingEconomics, Vantage, Fortune (Aug 21) — Brent ~\$93-95/bbl · Iranian state media (Aug 22) — Iran will allow Iraqi oil tankers through the Strait · Bitstamp — BTC \$77,266.84 (Aug 22 close, this cycle) vs. \$71,882.92 (Aug 20).
- August 18-20 verification:** Bloomberg, CNN, and CP24 (all Aug 18) — UAE reports two Iranian ballistic missiles fired at its territory, one landing in territorial waters; Iran's foreign ministry denies involvement, calls it a possible "false flag" · CNN, Washington Post, and Fortune (Aug 19) — UAE suspends all trade, commercial, and financial dealings with Iran · UK Maritime

- Trade Operations (Aug 18) — commercial vessel struck by unknown projectile in the Strait, engine damage, one crew injury · CBS and CNN (Aug 19) — Trump threatens "the most crushing economic operation ever taken against any country" (new sanctions rhetoric); same-day, Trump softens "no time schedule" framing, says US "might return to negotiations at some point... situation is so good" · TradingEconomics / Bloomberg (Aug 19) — Brent ~\$92/bbl · *Financial Times*, citing unnamed Iranian officials — *claim that Iran assessed potential strikes on US assets in Europe (Bulgaria airbase, Cyprus, fiber cables). Single-source, uncorroborated by any second outlet this cycle; logged as a watch item, explicitly NOT used to move any P.* · Bitstamp — BTC \$71,882.92 (Aug 20 close) vs. \$64,285.10 (Aug 18 close).
- **August 17-18 draft sources (never delivered as a report; independently re-verified this cycle against the above and found accurate):** CBS News — live desk, "Trump threatens to bomb Oman with Iran war stuck in stalemate as 60-day negotiation period ends" (Aug 17-18; MoU lapse, Iran's "US began violating" claim, Oman threat, Strait traffic 3-5 weekend transits vs. 31 prior weekend; pre-war baseline re-checked this cycle to ~110/day, not the ~130/day originally carried; Brent \$90.87) · CNN — "Deadline to reach US-Iran deal expires, Trump threatens Oman" (Aug 17) · Al Jazeera — live blog, MoU expiry coverage (Aug 17) · TradingEconomics — Brent \$90.97 (Aug 18).
 - **August 16 light daily check:** Al Jazeera — "UAE accuses Iran of attacks on two ADNOC vessels in Strait of Hormuz" (Aug 14) · CBS News — live desk, third ADNOC vessel hit Aug 15 (UKMTO), Vance remarks on energy-price priority, WTI ~\$81 · Bloomberg — "Iran, Oman Home In on Hormuz Strait Deal as Ship Attacks Mount" (Aug 15) — confirms the interim arrangement is still advancing, not collapsed, despite continued shipping attacks.
 - **August 14 light daily check:** US News — "Iran Says Deal on Strait of Hormuz Is Close but Not Enough to Open the Waterway" · NBC News — "Iran sets out steep demands for reopening Hormuz despite hopes Oman deal could break impasse" · Washington Post — "Iran says deal with Oman is close — but its demands leave Hormuz opening uncertain" · The Hill — "Iran's steep demands for US over Strait of Hormuz threaten to derail reopening" · Bloomberg — "Oil Holds Drop as Hormuz Deal Elusive While Ship Attacks Persist" (Aug 13) — all confirm the same stalled-on-compensation dispute, hardened not resolved; a live tracker (straits.live) shows day 166 of Strait closure.
 - **August 13 light daily check:** CNN — Hormuz agreement analysis, re-checked · NPR — Iran-Oman agreement terms, re-checked · Al Jazeera — "Iran deliberates Hormuz arrangement amid uncertain prospects with US" (Araghchi conditions reopening on US "making amends" over the June MoU) · Bloomberg, Fortune — Hormuz coverage archives, re-checked, no signing found as of Aug 13.
 - **August 11 light daily check:** NBC News, Al Jazeera, CBC, NPR, UPI, and Al Bawaba — six independent outlets corroborating the Aug 9 Houthi drone strike on Saudi Aramco's Jazan refinery, Saudi energy ministry statement of no injuries · Wikipedia "2026 Strait of Hormuz crisis" and Bloomberg/Marine Log Aug 5 route-agreement coverage re-checked — no signing found as of Aug 11.
 - **August 10 light daily check:** GlobalSecurity.org — day-by-day Iran war tracker, re-checked, no new entry since Aug 5 · Euronews and Al Jazeera — Hormuz coverage archives, re-checked, no new dated item · Wikipedia — "2026 Strait of Hormuz crisis" live tracker, re-checked, last update Aug 8 · no new dated catalyst found beyond these.
 - **August 9 light daily check:** Reuters — "Iran says deal on Strait of Hormuz is close but not enough to open the waterway," wire-distributed via Investing.com, US News, Jakarta Post, Japan Times, Haaretz, and Rappler (Aug 8-9) — Araqchi's "very close"/US-compensation comment, the UAE's new ship-hit report, and Oman's condemnation of "repeated attacks" all trace to this single Reuters wire story.
 - **August 8 full-weekly additions:** Bloomberg / UANI — Hormuz incident tracking, 65 cumulative incidents (Jul 31 - Aug 5) · globalsecurity.org — Gaslog Shanghai and Minoan Pioneer incident detail · CNN — "Iranian-backed proxies targeted Saudi Arabia, widening conflict in Middle East" (Aug 7) · Al Jazeera, Japan Times — Najran strike, 11 wounded, OIC statement (Aug 7) · wire coverage of the Saudi-Turkey-Pakistan mutual-defense pact (Aug 7) · Fortune — "Iran says agreement on Hormuz shipping reached with Oman" (Aug 7) and "Iran says it has a deal to reopen the Strait of Hormuz—and shipowners are outraged by its plan to charge fees" (Aug 6) · NPR — "Iran says agreement with Oman for Strait of Hormuz prohibits U.S. and Israeli vessels" (Aug 7) · Al Jazeera — "Iran, Oman, US 'close' to Hormuz deal: What do they all want?" (Aug 5) · Bloomberg — "Iran-Oman Deal Proposes Ban on US, Israeli Ships in Strait of Hormuz" (Aug 6) · CNBC — US official rejects one-sided fee/ban terms (Aug 6).
 - **August 7 additions:** Iranian FM spokesman Baghaei (via globalsecurity.org/IRNA relay) — joint statement "in final stage," under review pending no third-party obstruction · Pravda USA (AP-sourced wire relay) — "Shipping in the Strait of Hormuz will not be subject to fees until a final agreement is reached with Iran," citing US officials (Aug 7) · CNN live updates — continuing Iran/Oman/US Hormuz coverage, Iran's IRGC commander reiterates nuclear-development position (Aug 6-7) · ABC News live updates — Trump comments on US munitions stockpile.
 - **August 6 additions:** IRNA (via Bloomberg/Military.com relay) — Deputy FM Gharibabadi's "understanding in principle" statement · Bloomberg — "Iran Says Deal With Oman on Strait of Hormuz Agreed in Principle" (Aug 6) and "Iran, Oman Reach Agreement on Proposed Strait of Hormuz Shipping Route" (Aug 5) · CBS News — live updates, Iran/Oman deal getting close · Al Jazeera — "Iran, Oman, US 'close' to Hormuz deal: what do they all want?" (Aug 5) and "Hormuz deal 'close': what's the latest on each side's positions?" (Aug 6) · Euronews — "Iran and Oman agree route for ships" (Aug 5) · Fortune — "Iran says it has a deal to reopen the

- Strait of Hormuz—and shipowners are outraged by its plan to charge fees" (Aug 6), fee figures (5-7% Iran, ~3% Oman, 0% US) · Jerusalem Post — "Proposed Hormuz passage deal not feasible for shipping industry, sources say" · Forbes — "Hormuz Is Becoming A Fee-And-Permission Regime" (background, Jul 28) · Fast Company / DOL — jobless claims 199K week ended Aug 1, prior revised to 198K (Aug 6).
- **August 1-5 additions (prior week's catch-up):** [globalsecurity.org](#) — Iran War day-by-day tracker (Aug 1, Aug 4, Aug 5 entries) · Bloomberg — Qatari LNG tanker (Gaslog Shanghai) struck in the Strait (Aug 1-2) · UKMTO-sourced reporting via [globalsecurity.org](#) — second disabled tanker off Musandam · Al Jazeera, The National, DefenseMirror, Tribune — Saudi-led Multinational Maritime Defense Alliance, 14 members/43 nations (Aug 2) · NPR, Axios, Al Jazeera, NBC, Washington Times, Breitbart, JPost, Townhall, CNN — Trump cancels planned joint US-Israeli strike, "perimeters of a deal" (Aug 4) · [iransitrep.com](#) — bulkier struck and blacked out in the Strait (Aug 4) · Axios, Deccan Chronicle, Israel Hayom, InvestingLive, The National, Al-Quds — first public terms of a 60-day interim Hormuz deal (Aug 5) · CNN — live coverage, Gulf official cites 50-50 odds of an Iran-Oman deal by Friday (Aug 5).
 - **July 30 additions (prior full weekly refresh):** Al Jazeera — [Iran's IRGC strikes US base in Jordan \(Jul 28-29\)](#), corroborated by CNN, Axios, RT, Jerusalem Post · Al Jazeera — [US-Saudi joint strikes on Iraq, 20 killed](#), corroborated by CBS News and Foreign Policy · Al Jazeera — [drone strike on Egypt's Damietta port](#), corroborated by CNBC and Times of Israel · CNN — ["US renews strikes on Iran as widening war pulls in more countries"](#) (Jul 30) · Fortune — [Brent ~\\$92-93 \(Jul 30\)](#) · CNN — [Iran FM Baghaei denies direct US talks \(Jul 27\)](#).
 - **July 11-13 additions (prior full refresh — the escalation the light touches missed):** CENTCOM press releases — 3rd strike round (~140 targets, Jul 11) and 4th strike round (dozens more, first sea-launched attack drones, Jul 12) · Al Jazeera (multiple, Jul 12-13) — Hormuz-closed declaration, shipping-intelligence data via Windward, Oman strike coverage · Bloomberg (Jul 12) · NPR (Jul 11) · Washington Times (Jul 12) · The National (Jul 13) · Euronews (Jul 13) · Republic World and Peninsula Qatar (Jul 12) — Oman formal protest, ambassador summoned · Naharnet and Iran International — Iran/Oman/Qatar median-lane two-route corridor proposal · Business Recorder and RTÉ (Jul 13) — Iran FM spokesman Esmail Baqaei on continuing mediator talks · Middle East Eye and TASS — [GFS Galaxy attack and rescue \(Jul 11\)](#) · gCaptain — 3rd strike round detail · Kaiteur News — Iranian Health Ministry casualty figures (17 killed / 115 wounded, unverified government claim) · CryptoTimes, CoinDesk, Bitcoin.com, and Benzinga (Jul 13) — BTC weekend pullback to news-reported ~\$62,000–63,000 intraday range, mixed FOMC/CPI-vs-Iran attribution, first weekly BTC ETF inflow in nine weeks.
 - **July 11 additions (prior update):** CNN live — [Araghchi in Oman on Hormuz, Trump MoU "over" + decimate threat, expected Iranian safe-passage statement \(Jul 11\)](#) · CNBC — [Brent context, UAE record production \(referenced Jul 11\)](#).
 - **The escalation (official statements via wire reporting):** NPR — [second-night US strikes \(July 9\)](#) · Bloomberg — [attacks traded for second day \(July 9\)](#) · CENTCOM release — [second strike round \(403 at retrieval; cited via search\)](#) · Al Jazeera — [second-night strikes & the peace process \(July 9\)](#) · Gulf News — [Bushehr/Chabahar/Iranshahr strikes, Kuwait intercepts \(July 9\)](#) · The National — [Iran attacks on Gulf states & Jordan \(July 9\)](#) · RFE/RL — [Hormuz/Jordan \(403 at retrieval; cited via search\)](#) · NPR — [Hormuz tanker attacks \(July 7\)](#) · CBS live — [Treasury waiver revocation, CENTCOM 80+ targets, IRGC 85-site claim \(July 8\)](#) · Al Jazeera — [Trump "ceasefire over" quotes \(July 8\)](#).
 - **Diplomacy:** Al Jazeera — [talks status, no formal MoU withdrawal, Khamenei burial \(July 10\)](#) · Al Jazeera — [mediators urge MoU compliance \(July 9\)](#) · CNN live — [Trump on talks / "Cease Fire is OVER", Qatari team to Tehran \(July 10; 451 at retrieval, cited via search\)](#) · Times of Israel — [July 11 talks date via Al Arabiya \(single-source relay, unconfirmed\)](#) · Times of Israel liveblog — [Israel-join-strikes report \(July 10; single-source, unconfirmed\)](#) · Al Jazeera — [Doha outcomes \(July 2\)](#).
 - **The oil waiver:** CBS — [GL X1 waiver rescission \(July 7\)](#) · Axios — [waiver revocation \(July 7\)](#) · The Hill — [sanctions detail \(July 7\)](#).
 - **The prices:** Fortune — [Brent ~\\$76.00–76.80 \(July 10\)](#) · Kitco/Reuters — [oil fell as markets weigh strikes \(July 9\)](#) · Sunday Guardian — [Brent ~\\$76 / WTI <\\$72 \(July 10; weaker source\)](#) · CNBC — [Brent \\$78.02 / WTI \\$73.52 \(July 8\)](#) · Insurance Journal — [traffic near halt, war-risk 2–6% of hull value \(July 9\)](#) · The New Arab — [JMIC "severe" advisory](#) · LMA — [insurance availability vs safety concerns](#) · *(Hormuz traffic magnitude conflicts across outlets — ~50% of pre-war vs ~92% drop — transponders off; pre-attack throughput figures are from the unofficial straits.live tracker — single-source)* · CoinDesk — [BTC steady above \\$62K \(July 9\)](#) · CoinDesk — [BTC to ~\\$64K on chips/yen, not Iran \(July 10\)](#) · Fortune — [BTC ~\\$61.7K \(July 6, pre-escalation\)](#) · CoinDesk — [~\\$450M liquidations \(July 8\)](#).
 - **The odds (sentiment only, not fact):** Blockchain.News — [invasion odds 11.5% → 14.5% \(~July 8 print\)](#) · Blockchain.News — [Hormuz-normal-by-July odds collapse to 4.5% \(403 at retrieval; cited via search\)](#) · Direct Polymarket [fetch failed twice this week \(July 13\)](#); ["US invades Iran before 2027" relayed via secondary aggregators only — inconsistent snapshots ~14.5% \(Jul 8\) → ~15.5% \(~Jul 10\) → ~17% \(most recent\), inconsistency itself flagged. "MoU withdrawal by Jul 31" reads \(~5–7%, dated ~Jul 3–5\) and "final deal by Dec 31" \(35.5% last verified Jul 8\) are stale and not re-verified this week.](#)